

GNOME Desktop Cheat-Sheet

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Stock Fedora 44 GNOME – no theming, no extensions beyond Fedora’s own **background-logo**. Reverted to defaults 2026-07-23. The old Windows-like rice (dash-to-panel, ArcMenu, Nord colors) is still in this repo behind the **gnome-nord** script if it’s ever wanted back; see [Recovery](#).

Overview & apps

Key	Action
Super	Activities overview (windows + workspaces + search)
Type after Super	Search apps/files, Enter to launch
Super + A	Application grid
Alt + F2	Run-command prompt
Top-left hot corner	Overview (mouse)

Favorites live in the dash on the left of the overview – right-click an app to pin. Add custom launch hotkeys in Settings > Keyboard > Custom Shortcuts.

Windows

Key	Action
Alt + Tab	Switch between applications (grouped)
Alt + `	Switch between windows of the current app
Super + Left/Right	Snap window to half screen (or drag to edge)
Super + Up	Maximize (or drag to top edge)
Super + Down	Unmaximize / restore
Super + H	Minimize (“hide”)
Alt + F4	Close window
Alt + F7 / Alt + F8	Move / resize with the keyboard
F11	Fullscreen (app-dependent)

Workspaces

Key	Action
Super + Page Up / Page Down	Previous / next workspace
Super + Shift + Page Up / Page Down	Move window to prev/next workspace
Ctrl + Alt + Left / Right	Previous / next workspace (alternate)
3-finger touchpad swipe up	Overview (all windows + workspaces)
4-finger touchpad swipe left/right	Switch workspace

Media / system

Volume, brightness, and media keys are handled natively by GNOME. System menu (network, bluetooth, battery, power off): top-right of the top bar. Lock screen: **Super** + **Shift** + **L**.

Terminal apps

Command	Action
<code>y</code>	yazi (in any terminal) – <code>cds</code> to wherever you exited
<code>yazi</code>	yazi without the <code>cd-on-exit</code> behavior

Shell power-ups (zsh)

All emulator-agnostic – these work in Ghostty, Ptyxis, gnome-terminal, and over SSH. Every hook is guarded, so the same `.zshrc` is safe on a minimal box. | Key / Command | Action | |—| | **Ctrl-R** | Fuzzy search command history (fzf) | | **Ctrl-T** | Fuzzy-pick a file/path into the current command (fzf) | | **Alt-C** | Fuzzy `cd` into a subdirectory (fzf) | | **z <part>** | Jump to a frecent directory by fragment (zoxide) | | **zi** | Interactive zoxide directory picker | | Right arrow / **Ctrl-E** | Accept the greyed-out autosuggestion | | **ll** / **la** | eza long / long-all listing (git status + icons) | | **lt** | eza tree, 2 levels deep | | **lg** | lazygit (git TUI) | | **zellij** | terminal multiplexer (tmux alternative) | | **direnv allow** | Trust an `.envrc` so its env loads on `cd` |

Installed toolbox

Everything added this session, in brief. Run any of these from a terminal.

CLI / shell

Tool	What it does
fzf	Fuzzy finder; powers Ctrl-R / Ctrl-T / Alt-C above
fd	Fast, friendly find replacement
zoxide	z – jump to directories by frequency
eza	Modern ls (git status, icons, tree)
bat	cat with syntax highlighting + paging
git-delta	Pretty side-by-side git diffs (wired into git)
lazygit (lg)	Full-screen git TUI
zellij	Terminal multiplexer (panes/tabs; tmux alternative)
procs	Modern ps
hyperfine	Command benchmarking tool
ncdu	Interactive disk-usage browser
tealdeer (tldr)	Fast, example-first man pages
yq	Like jq , but for YAML
glow	Render Markdown in the terminal
chafa	Show images as terminal graphics

Dev

Tool	What it does
nvim	Neovim editor
just	Command runner (a saner make for tasks)
direnv	Auto-load per-project env from <code>.envrc</code>

Tool	What it does
distrobox	Run other distros' tools in containers
shellcheck	Lints shell scripts for bugs
http	HTTPIe – human-friendly curl

Files / transfer / backup

Tool	What it does
croc	Send files between machines via a code phrase
rclone	Sync to/from cloud storage (rsync for clouds)
restic	Fast encrypted snapshot backups
aria2c	Multi-connection downloader
syncthing	Continuous peer-to-peer folder sync
trash-put	Send files to the trash instead of <code>rm</code>

Network / security

Tool	What it does
nmap	Network/port scanner
wireshark	Packet capture + analysis (GUI)
gping	Ping with a live graph
age	Simple modern file encryption
testdisk / photorec	Recover lost partitions / deleted files
lynis	Local security-hardening audit

System / hardware

Tool	What it does
nvtop	GPU usage monitor (watch the RTX 5070)
powertop	Power draw analysis + tunables
s-tui	Stress test + live CPU temp/freq TUI

Gaming

Tool	What it does
mangohud	In-game FPS/perf overlay (<code>mangohud <game></code>)
goverlay	GUI to configure MangoHud
gamescope	Micro-compositor for games (scaling, framecap)
Lutris	Launcher for non-Steam / Windows games
Heroic	Epic / GOG / Amazon games launcher (Flatpak)
ProtonUp-Qt	Manage Proton-GE versions (Flatpak)

Terminal toys

Tool	What it does
<code>cmatrix</code>	Matrix rain
<code>cava</code>	Audio spectrum visualizer
<code>asciiquarium</code>	ASCII aquarium
<code>cowsay</code> / <code>lolcat</code> / <code>figlet</code>	ASCII cow / rainbow pipe / big text

GUI apps (Flatpak)

OBS Studio (recording/streaming), Krita (painting), GIMP (photo editing), Inkscape (vector), Blender (3D), Audacity (audio), HandBrake (video transcode), Obsidian (notes), Bitwarden (passwords), Flameshot (screenshot annotate), LocalSend (AirDrop-style transfer).

yazi keybinds

Key	Action
<code>j</code> / <code>k</code> or arrows	Move down / up
<code>h</code> / <code>l</code> or arrows	Parent dir / enter dir
<code>H</code> / <code>L</code>	Back / forward in history
<code>gg</code> / <code>G</code>	Top / bottom
<code>gh</code>	Go home (~)
<code>gc</code>	Go to ~/.config
<code>gd</code>	Go to ~/Downloads
<code><Space></code>	Toggle selection on current file
<code>v</code> / <code>V</code>	Visual select mode / visual unset mode
<code>Ctrl+a</code> / <code>Ctrl+r</code>	Select all / invert selection
<code>y</code> / <code>x</code> / <code>p</code> / <code>P</code>	Yank (copy) / cut / paste / paste (overwrite)
<code>d</code> / <code>D</code>	Trash / permanently delete
<code>a</code>	Create file (end with / for a directory)
<code>r</code>	Rename
<code>o</code> / <code>Enter</code>	Open
<code>O</code> / <code>Shift+Enter</code>	Open interactively (pick app)
<code>.</code>	Toggle hidden files
<code>/</code> / <code>?</code>	Find next / previous
<code>s</code> / <code>S</code>	Search by name (fd) / by content (ripgrep)
<code>f</code>	Filter files
<code>tt</code>	New tab in current dir
<code>1-9</code>	Switch to tab N
<code>[</code> / <code>]</code>	Previous / next tab
<code>,</code> then <code>m/a/s/e/n</code>	Sort by mtime / alphabetical / size / extension / natural (Shift = reverse)
<code>w</code>	Task manager
<code>~</code> or <code>F1</code>	Help (full keymap, searchable)
<code>q</code>	Quit

GPU offload

Run any app on the NVIDIA dGPU instead of the AMD iGPU (GNOME always runs on AMD, since it drives the panel):

```
dgpu-run <command>
# e.g.
dgpu-run flatpak run org.prismlauncher.PrismLauncher
```

Songs of Syx mods

The game runs its Windows build under Proton and does not see Steam Workshop subscriptions on its own, so the launcher's MODS tab shows up empty. `syx-mods-sync` symlinks every subscribed mod into the Proton prefix so the launcher lists them:

```
syx-mods-sync      # safe to re-run; prints what it linked
```

It runs automatically on game launch via Steam launch options (`syx-mods-sync; %command%`), so a new subscription is there next time you start. After subscribing you still have to tick the mod in the launcher's MODS tab, and mods must be enabled *before* starting a world.

Mods are linked, not copied, so Workshop updates apply with no action. Unsubscribing leaves a dead link that the next run cleans up. Hand-placed mod folders are real directories and are never touched.

WiFi

GNOME's system menu (top-right of the taskbar) lists and connects to networks. The `wifi` script still works from any terminal:

```
wifi                # interactive picker
wifi "GC Public"    # connect straight to a named network
```

Saved networks reconnect without a prompt; new ones ask for a password. On a captive portal you'll associate but have no route out until you open any `http://` page and sign in.

Recovery

The login screen is GDM, stock and unthemed (Fedora's default). SDDM and its Nord theme are still installed but inactive.

- **GNOME session won't start / crashes at login:** from a TTY, check `journalctl --user -b -u org.gnome.Shell@wayland.service` (or `journalctl -b -p err`). `Ctrl+Alt+F1` (or `F2`) back to the graphical screen.
- **Session hung:** `loginctl terminate-user cross` from a TTY force-kills it and drops back to the login screen.
- **Want the old Windows-like rice back:** `stow gtk && gnome-nord`, then log out/in. That re-enables dash-to-panel, ArcMenu and appindicator, restores the Nord colors and the per-window Alt-Tab, and re-applies the generated wallpaper. If ArcMenu is gone entirely (e.g. after a GNOME major upgrade breaks compatibility), reinstall the matching version from extensions.gnome.org (`gnome-extensions install <zip>`).
- **Desperate fallback session:** pick "GNOME Classic" at the login screen's session picker – ugly but always works. Normal logins should use plain "GNOME".